Northern Lights

A short tour of the aurora — where it comes from, when to look, and how to photograph it

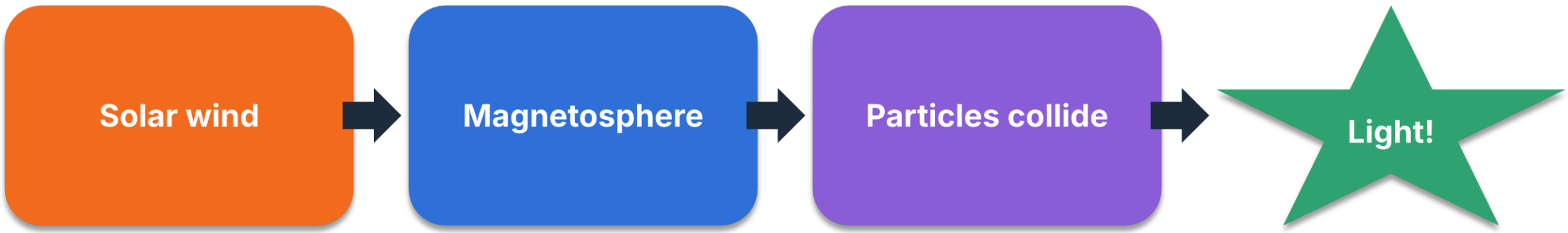
What we'll cover

- The science: solar wind meets the magnetosphere
- Where and when to see it
  - High latitudes, dark skies, long winter nights
  - Kp index and space-weather forecasts
- Photographing the aurora
- Safety and etiquette in the field

The Science

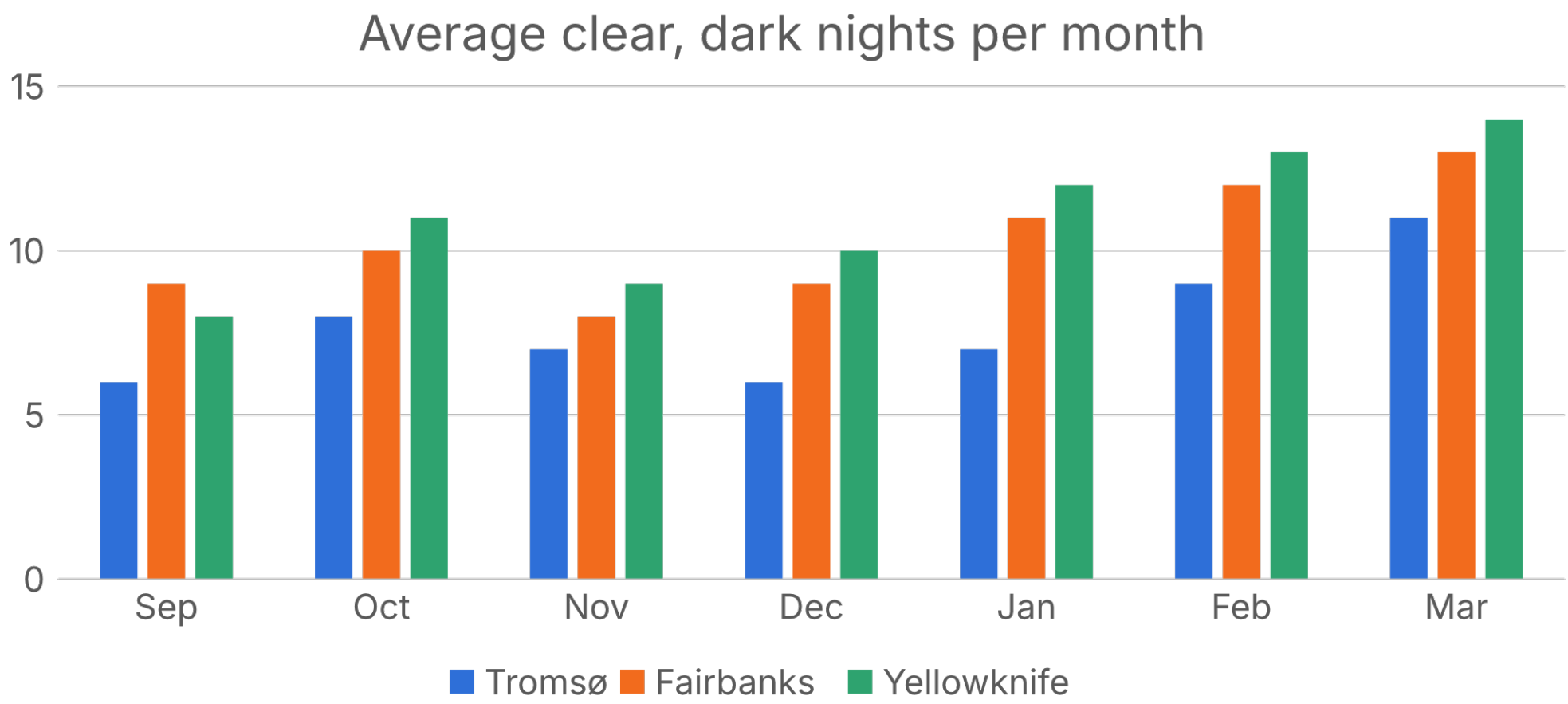
Charged particles, magnetic fields and glowing gases

From the Sun to your sky



Oxygen glows green and red; nitrogen adds blue and purple fringes.

Best months to look (clear nights)



Camera settings that work

Setting	Faint aurora	Bright, active aurora
Aperture	f/1.4 – f/2.8	f/2.8
Shutter	8 – 15 s	1 – 4 s
ISO	1600 – 3200	800 – 1600
Focus	Manual, on a bright star	Manual, on a bright star

Field checklist

- Bring
  - Tripod and spare batteries
  - Headlamp with a red mode
  - Warm layers and a thermos
- Remember
  - Check the forecast and cloud cover
  - Let your eyes adapt for 20 minutes
  - Leave no trace



Clear skies!

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